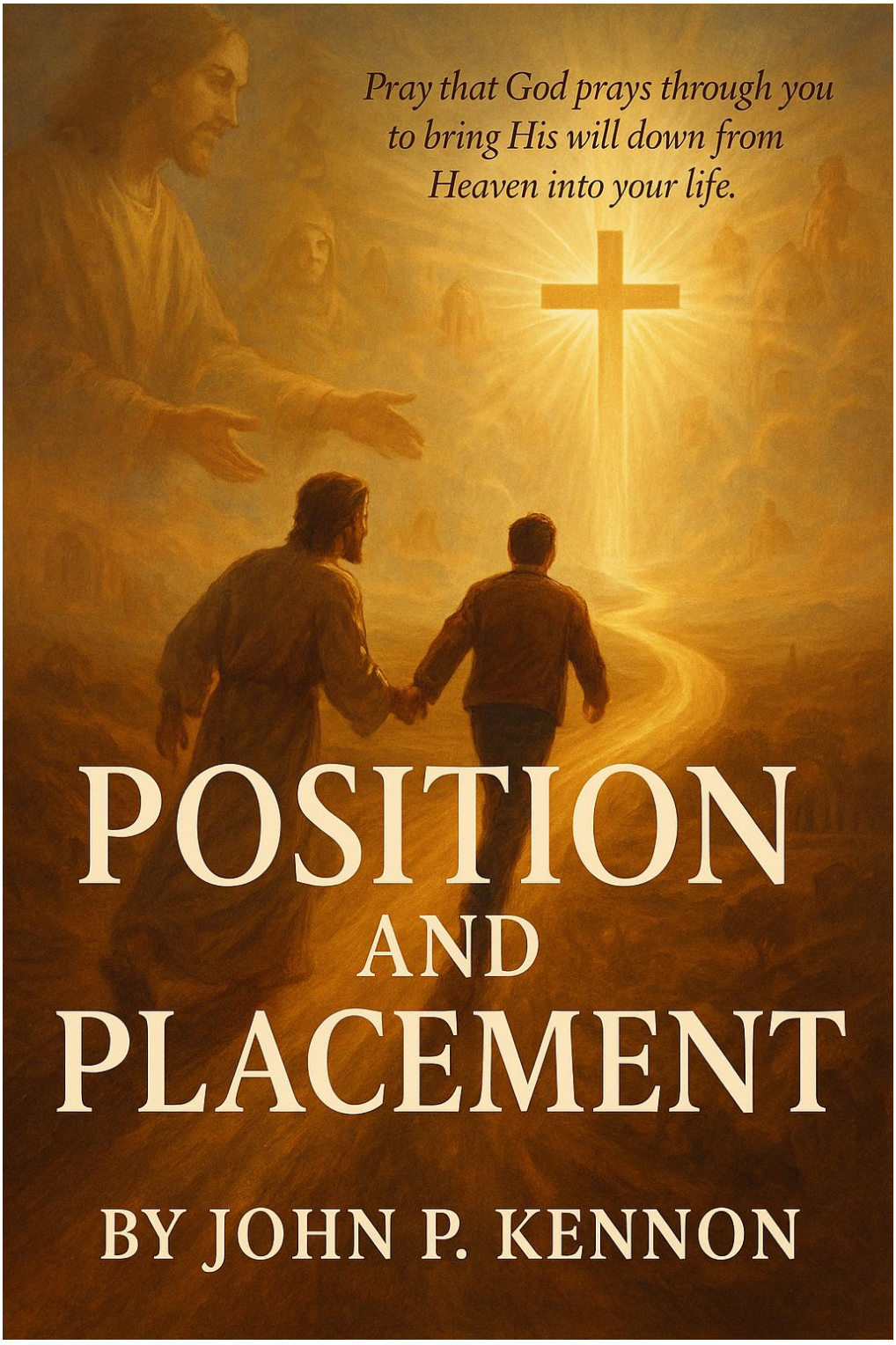

Pray that God prays through you
to bring His will down from
Heaven into your life.
POSITION
AND
PLACEMENT
BY JOHN P. KENNON

Position and Placement

Bro. John Kennon

He is going to lead you to it so he can lead you through it!
Your “position in God and understanding of that position will directly determine your “placement” in His will.

As an opening text for this book, I chose the following passage in Hebrews. It illustrates the initial calling of a Christian but emphasizes further deeper and wider calling to grow from a sapling rooted in Christ into a forest of trees for generations to come and enjoy. It calls for us to find the river of living water and allow it to not only wash us clean but bring forth living water that is a wellspring of life for others.

Heb 6:1 Therefore leaving the principles of the doctrine of Christ, let us go on unto perfection; not laying again the foundation of repentance from dead works, and of faith toward God,
Heb 6:2 Of the doctrine of baptisms, and of laying on of hands, and of resurrection of the dead, and of eternal judgment.
Heb 6:3 And this will we do, if God permit.

To give a summary of the contents of this book I have written a storybook style opening introducing two characters named Silas and Ephraim.

As you read put yourself in their shoes and imagine if you can relate.

A NEW BEGINNING ON THE NARROW TRAIL

Ephraim tightened the leather straps on his worn sandals, squinting under the morning sun. The path winding before him was steep and rocky, disappearing high into the mist-shrouded mountains. A gentle breeze ruffled his hair, carrying the scent of pine and promise. Behind him, a peaceful valley spread out—fields he'd sown, lessons he'd learned, comfort he could cling to. But something in his heart whispered that there was more; a higher place calling him onward.

He recalled an evening by the fire when his wise mentor, Silas, had opened a scroll of ancient words. "*Therefore leaving the principles of the doctrine of Christ, let us go on unto perfection…*" Silas read from Hebrews. "We must press forward, Ephraim—beyond the simple beginnings—because our King desires to grow us in faith. Sometimes He leads us to lofty summits just to show us He can guide us *through* them."

Ephraim remembered Silas tracing a knot of rope in his hands as he taught. "Your *position* in God," Silas had explained, "is how you stand before Him—rooted in truth, sure of your calling. But that *position* must settle firmly in your soul if you want to walk in your *placement*, that unique purpose He has for you. If you're not grounded in who you are, you'll be shaken by every challenge." At sunrise the next day, Ephraim found a small parchment tucked under his door. On it, Silas had written: *He is going to lead you to it so He can lead you through it.* That cryptic message echoed in Ephraim's mind as he now took the first step up the winding trail. Each footfall felt like a small act of faith. He was leaving behind the "elementary teachings"—like a child leaving a beloved sandbox—to pursue something deeper and richer in God.

The climb tested him. Loose stones slid beneath his feet, stinging dust coated his throat. By midday, he collapsed against a boulder, exhausted and uncertain if he could continue. Doubts buzzed in his mind: *Am I in the right place? Should I have stayed in the valley? Maybe I'm not ready.*

But then he remembered the words: *not laying again the foundation of repentance from dead works, and of faith toward God.* This journey was about moving forward—trusting that the One who called him was strong enough to support him.

Leaning his head back against the warm stone, Ephraim prayed, "Lord, I believe You led me here. Show me the next step. Help me keep going." A quiet peace replaced his panic. He rose, dusted himself off, and pressed on.



In his heart, he sensed that every challenge on this trail was part of God's *positioning*—an invitation to grow in endurance and courage. And he trusted that, in time, his King would *place* him where he needed to be. The path would grow steeper still—he knew that—but "if God permit," as the Scripture said, Ephraim would climb to new heights he'd never dreamed possible.

And so, with renewed resolve, he set his eyes on the summit, footsteps carrying him closer to the destiny waiting just beyond the clouds.

In the grand tapestry of God's plan, each life is a thread woven with purpose. Imagine a King writing a wondrous tale, carefully crafting every chapter so that each character finds the right spot at just the right moment. That's how our heavenly Author works—He positions us in one place to prepare us and then places us where we truly belong. Let's meet a few remarkable characters from His story:

Joseph: The Dreamer in the Dungeon
Long ago, there was a young man named Joseph who had bright dreams shimmering in his heart. But his jealous brothers sold him into slavery, sending him far from home. Though Joseph found himself in Egypt doing chores for Potiphar and later chained in prison, he never forgot the shining dreams God had given him. You see, Joseph was *positioned*—trained in humility and service—even when it felt like a dark dungeon of despair. In time, the King of Egypt discovered Joseph's gift for interpreting dreams and invited him to the palace. In a single day, Joseph went from wearing prison rags to wearing royal robes. Finally *placed* in a position of authority, Joseph saved countless lives during a terrible famine. His story reminds us that the lonely seasons often shape us for the palace moments ahead.

Moses: The Deliverer from the Palace
Centuries before, a Hebrew baby named Moses floated in a basket on the Nile, rescued by Pharaoh's daughter. Raised as royalty, Moses lived in the grand courts of Egypt, never knowing he would one day free his people from slavery. After a rash decision drove him into the wilderness, Moses spent years tending sheep, learning patience and leadership the quiet way. This was his *positioning*—a desert classroom under God's watchful eye. Finally, when the moment was right, God *placed* him back in Egypt to confront Pharaoh with a mighty message: "Let my people go." Moses led the Israelites across the Red Sea and into the wilderness toward the Promised Land, proving that even the desert years can prepare us for a divine destiny.

David: Shepherd Boy Turned King
Some stories begin with the humblest tasks—like tending sheep under an open sky. David was the youngest son in a big family, overlooked by everyone but God. While David guarded his flock, he became skilled with a slingshot and learned to trust the Lord. That was his *positioning*—quiet hours with sheep, practicing courage when lions and bears threatened the flock. Then came the day he faced Goliath the giant and later found himself anointed as king of Israel. In God's perfect timing, David was *placed* on the throne, where his shepherd's heart guided an entire nation.

Esther and Mary: Two Courageous Women
Esther was an orphan girl who unexpectedly found herself chosen as queen. Positioned in a palace of a foreign land, she discovered God had *placed* her there "for such a time as this" to save her people. Likewise, Mary grew up in modest surroundings but was chosen to become the mother of Jesus. Humble and faithful, she said yes to God's astonishing plan, carrying the Savior of the world. Both women show us that a willing heart matters more than a grand background.

King Uzziah: A Cautionary Tale
Not every story ends happily. King Uzziah began in the right position—receiving wisdom and success from God—but pride led him astray. He took for himself a priestly role that did not belong to him, forgetting that only God decides placement. Uzziah's downfall teaches us to stay humble, trusting God to lift us up instead of grabbing positions ourselves.

From Joseph to David, Esther to Mary, we see that *position* always comes before *placement.* The desert, the pasture, or even a prison cell may be part of God's divine blueprint. If we remain faithful and humble in the position where He prepares us, we can rest assured that He will place us exactly where we need to be—ready to shine for His glory. When our heavenly Author draws a line in the sand and declares "Enough," we can confidently walk forward, trusting that His victory awaits just ahead.

There is a maturing in Christ that God desires of all people. He desires us to go from glory to glory and from faith to faith abiding in Him in love. But there is a biblical process that God uses as we will discuss in this message. This Christian experience is NOT just some biweekly experience that we either choose or deny on a regular basis. But it is a lifechanging power that transform us from what we were into what we could never be on our own. There are also gifts and callings that require preparation for that position and placement into his will. What is the ultimate will of God for all of us? To become fellow laborers in the work of the church in the earth and to live in the unity of the faith. Thy will be done IN earth as it is in Heaven!

1Co 12:27 Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.
1Co 12:28 And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues.
1Co 12:29 Are all apostles? are all prophets? are all teachers? are all workers of miracles?
1Co 12:30 Have all the gifts of healing? do all speak with tongues? do all interpret?
1Co 12:31 But covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.

Summary: 1 Corinthians 12:27–31 emphasizes that all believers are individual members of the body of Christ, each with unique roles and spiritual gifts. God has appointed various roles within the church, such as apostles, prophets, teachers, and gifts like miracles, healing, and speaking in tongues. While not everyone has the same gifts, believers are encouraged to desire the most impactful ones and to pursue the higher way of love.

- Believers collectively form the body of Christ, each as a unique member.
- God appoints different roles in the church, including apostles, prophets, and teachers.

- Other gifts include miracles, healing, helps, governance, and speaking in various tongues.
- Not everyone possesses the same gifts or roles within the church.
- Believers are encouraged to seek the most beneficial spiritual gifts.
- The highest pursuit is a more excellent way, which is the way of love.

The "TRADITIONAL" definition of Sin

1. **Definition of Sin:**
    - **Moral Failure:** Sin often refers to actions or thoughts that violate God's commandments or moral law (e.g., Lev 4:2, 1Jn 3:4).
    - **Disobedience to God:** It includes both active rebellion and passive neglect of God's commands (e.g., Gen 4:7, Num 15:24).
    - **Ignorance or Error:** Sin can also occur unintentionally, yet still requires atonement (e.g., Lev 4:13, Num 15:27).

2. **The Nature of Sin:**
    - **Universality:** All humans are subject to sin and its consequences (e.g., Rom 3:23, Rom 5:12).
    - **Progressive and Ensnaring:** Sin is depicted as something that can grow and enslave if not addressed (e.g., Gen 4:7, Rom 6:16).
    - **Contrary to God's Nature:** Sin separates humanity from God's holiness (e.g., Isa 59:2, 1Jn 1:8).

3. **Consequences of Sin:**
    - **Spiritual Death:** Sin leads to separation from God, symbolized as spiritual death (e.g., Rom 6:23, Jas 1:15).
    - **Divine Judgment:** Persistent sin provokes God's judgment and wrath (e.g., Gen 18:20, Rom 1:18).

- **Corporate and Personal Impact:** Sin affects individuals and communities, spreading its influence and consequences (e.g., Num 16:22, Jer 17:1).

4. **Response to Sin:**
   - **Atonement:** The sacrificial system in the Old Testament provided a means for atonement and reconciliation with God (e.g., Lev 4:20, Heb 9:26).
   - **Confession and Forgiveness:** Acknowledging sin and seeking forgiveness restores the relationship with God (e.g., Psa 32:5, 1Jn 1:9).
   - **Repentance:** Turning away from sin and pursuing righteousness is a recurring theme (e.g., Eze 18:21, Mat 4:17).
5. **Jesus and Sin:**
   - **Ultimate Sacrifice:** Jesus' death is described as the ultimate atonement for sin, fulfilling the Old Testament sacrifices (e.g., Isa 53:10, Heb 10:18).
   - **Victory Over Sin:** Through Jesus, believers are freed from the dominion of sin and empowered to live righteously (e.g., Rom 6:6, 1Jn 3:5).
   - **Advocate for the Sinner:** Jesus acts as an advocate for those who sin, providing grace and intercession (e.g., 1Jn 2:1).

6. **Practical Implications:**
   - **Avoidance of Sin:** Believers are urged to resist sin through obedience and dependence on God (e.g., Rom 6:12, 1Co 15:34).
   - **Community Responsibility:** Sin's impact on others highlights the importance of accountability and guidance within the faith community (e.g., Lev 19:17, Gal 6:1).
   - **Living in Grace:** While sin exists, God's grace is emphasized as sufficient to forgive and empower a new life (e.g., Rom 5:20, Eph 2:8).

In essence, sin is a central concept in scripture, representing humanity's deviation from God's will, its pervasive consequences,

and the divine provision for redemption through atonement and grace. However if we look at the to defined sin we see a very unique manner in which Gods word defines sin. Starting here in Romans and working back to the garden we see a clear picture of what sin really is.

Rom 14:23 And he that doubteth is damned if he eat, because *he eateth* not of faith: for whatsoever *is* not of faith is sin.
Jesus defined the inner man as the place iniquity comes from.
Mat_7:23 And then will I profess unto them, I never knew you: depart from me, ye that work iniquity.
Mat_13:41 The Son of man shall send forth his angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom all things that offend, and them which do iniquity;
Mat_23:28 Even so ye also outwardly appear righteous unto men, but within ye are full of hypocrisy and iniquity.
Mat_24:12 And because iniquity shall abound, the love of many shall wax cold.
Luk_13:27 But he shall say, I tell you, I know you not whence ye are; depart from me, all *ye* workers of iniquity.

Contrast these passages with Jesus discussion with the rich young ruler who performed all of his duties to Gods law faithfully. In spite of this he desperately still came up short, in spite of being wealthy and righteous in his duties as a Jew all because he lacked on thing. Faith. Faith in God doing far greater than he would or could ever have accomplished on his own.

God's discussion with CAIN

Gen_4:7 If thou doest well, shalt thou not be accepted? and if thou doest not well, sin lieth at the door. And unto thee *shall be* his desire, and thou shalt rule over him.
Finally the God's discussion with Adam and Eve in the Garden where sin began.
Gen_4:7 If thou doest well, shalt thou not be accepted? and if thou doest not well, sin lieth at the door. And unto thee *shall be* his desire, and thou shalt rule over him.

Sin as defined by scripture is simply trying to be like God apart from Faith!

This is essential in understanding where sin's position is in our lives. And essentially where our position in God is prior to and post born again experience. When we try to be like God without Faith we position ourselves OUTSIDE of His knowledge of us and thus work iniquity. This in a practical manner means sin is more about the condition of the heart than anything else.

- When we pray do we pray in faith?
- When we come to church do we engage faith and believe for great things?
- When we sing do we believe in our hearts what we are singing?
- If Paul addresses eating meats sin, how much more does our Christian lifestyle and duties need to be carefully examined?
- Even down to the mind and heart of the matter?
- If we are doing these things in faith?

Assumption is not faith. Faith has substance and evidence in God. It is real tangible and powerful. This boils down to RELATIONSHIP with God on a level that should rival any human relationship greater than our parents and or spouse or even our children.
Jesus gave us the example of those that do great works in his name yet still come up short. But the synergy of faith and works make it perfect and whole in God's eyes.

Key Aspects of "Workers of Iniquity":

1. **Definition of Iniquity**:
    - Iniquity refers to moral corruption, wickedness, or sin, particularly of a deeper, habitual nature. It goes beyond single acts of sin to indicate a lifestyle or practice of wrongdoing (e.g., Psalm 5:5, Psalm 6:8).

2. **Characteristics of Workers of Iniquity**:
    - **Deliberate Sinfulness**: They knowingly and persistently engage in actions contrary to God's will (e.g., Luke 13:27).
    - **Rebellion Against God**: Their behavior reflects a rejection of God's authority and moral laws (e.g., Proverbs 21:15).
    - **Hypocrisy**: They may outwardly appear righteous while inwardly harboring wickedness (e.g., Matthew 7:21-23).

3. **Biblical Context**:

    - **Old Testament**:
        - Workers of iniquity are associated with oppressors, liars, and those who shed innocent blood (e.g., Psalm 28:3, Psalm 94:4).
        - God is portrayed as opposing and judging workers of iniquity (e.g., Psalm 5:5, Psalm 37:1-2).
    - **New Testament**:
        - Jesus warns that workers of iniquity will be denied entry into the kingdom of heaven, even if they perform outwardly religious acts (e.g., Matthew 7:23, Luke 13:27).
        - They are contrasted with those who do the will of God and live righteously.
4. **Divine Judgment**:
    - **Separation from God**: Workers of iniquity are often described as being rejected or cast away from God's presence (e.g., Luke 13:27).
    - **Future Judgment**: They face divine punishment for their deeds, as their actions lead to destruction (e.g., Psalm 37:38, Proverbs 10:29).
5. **Examples in Scripture**:
    - **Oppressors and Evildoers**: Those who exploit others, practice deceit, or act unjustly (e.g., Micah 2:1-3).

- **Hypocritical Religious Leaders**: Jesus rebuked Pharisees and others who practiced iniquity under the guise of righteousness (e.g., Matthew 23:27-28).

6. **Contrasts with the Righteous**:
   - Workers of iniquity are contrasted with the righteous, who strive to live according to God's laws and seek His favor (e.g., Psalm 37:9, Proverbs 10:29).

In summary, "workers of iniquity" in the Bible signifies those who consistently and willfully engage in wickedness, disregarding God's authority and righteousness. They are objects of God's displeasure and are often warned of impending judgment unless they repent and turn from their ways.

Iniquity, Sin and Faith

We are not trying to remove the generally accepted definition of sin as explained previously, however we are simply adding a dimension that isn't discussed enough to give it justice. Let us consider a scripture that correlates to both faith and sin. In Romans 14 Paul condemns

Unity in the Body of Christ
Eph 4:4 *There is* one body, and one Spirit, even as ye are called in one hope of your calling;
Eph 4:5 One Lord, one faith, one baptism,
Eph 4:6 One God and Father of all, who *is* above all, and through all, and in you all.
Eph 4:7 But unto every one of us is given grace according to the measure of the gift of Christ.
Eph 4:8 Wherefore he saith, When he ascended up on high, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts unto men.
Eph 4:11 And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers;
Eph 4:12 For the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ:

Eph 4:13 Till we all come in the unity of the faith, and of the knowledge of the Son of God, unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fulness of Christ:

- Believers are encouraged to live in a manner worthy of their calling.
- Emphasize humility, patience, and love to foster unity and peace.
- Recognize that there is one unified body, Spirit, hope, Lord, faith, baptism, and God who is present in all.
- Christ bestows grace to each believer in unique measures.
- The church comprises specific roles: apostles, prophets, evangelists, pastors, and teachers.
- These roles are designed to build, strengthen, and guide the church, nurturing spiritual growth among believers.
- The importance of ministry is emphasized for helping individuals find their purpose in God and their place in His Kingdom.
- The goal is to achieve unity in faith and knowledge of the Son of God.
- Believers are called to grow spiritually and remain vigilant against deception.
- Growth should be rooted in truth and love, with Christ as the head of the church.
- The church should function as a unified body, with each member contributing to its overall growth and strength.

RIGHT PLACEMENT FAILED POSITION

PRIDE AND UNBELIEF

King Uzziah, also known as Azariah, was one of Judah's longest-reigning kings, ruling for 52 years during the 8th century BCE. His reign is described in the Bible, mainly in 2 Chronicles 26 and 2 Kings 15. Uzziah ascended to the throne at 16 and led Judah to significant achievements in military, economic, and infrastructural realms.

Key Contributions

1. **Military Success**: Uzziah fortified Jerusalem with advanced defenses and expanded Judah's territory. He led successful military campaigns against the Philistines, Arabs, and Meunites, strengthening Judah's security and influence.
2. **Economic Development**: He invested in agricultural advancements, expanding vineyards and building water reservoirs, which bolstered Judah's economy and made it more self-sufficient.
3. **Infrastructure and Technology**: Uzziah modernized Judah's military equipment, even introducing innovative siege engines and fortifications, which showcased his focus on defense and development.
4. **Religious Reforms**: Initially, he followed in his father Amaziah's footsteps, seeking guidance from prophets and upholding a degree of religious observance in Judah.

Downfall

Despite his achievements, Uzziah's pride led to his downfall. Later in his reign, he attempted to burn incense in the Temple, a rite reserved only for priests. This act of arrogance resulted in God striking him with leprosy, leading to his isolation. Uzziah lived in a separate house, while his son Jotham governed in his place. His leprosy remained until his death, symbolizing the consequences of overstepping his divinely appointed role as king.

- King Uzziah's legacy remains a powerful reminder of the importance of humility and respect for religious boundaries, it is difficult at best to try balancing his notable contributions with his tragic end due to pride.
- He succeeded His father, and his "placement" was into leadership, but his failure of this "position" in what mattered most caused him to fall.
- You can be called and placed in the right position but miss the placement within your calling

- His reign was generally viewed positively until his later years, when pride led him to overstep boundaries in religious practices, resulting in his leprosy.
- But it is when king Uzziah died that Isaiah saw the lord high and lifted up
- There are some things you will have to go through that may cause you pain in this life.
- But when you let the position and placement the world left you in die,
- It's then you will see the lord high and lifted up and his train will fill the temple.

End of sample

Thank you for reading the opening of Position and Placement.

The full edition is being prepared for publication.

highergroundministries.church